

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Sadananda Ganna

Address: 119A Burdon Lane Cheam SM2 7DB

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:1. Existing Traffic Congestion and Peak-Time Pressure

The proposed site is located in an area already experiencing substantial traffic congestion and acute peak-time pressure. The surrounding road network frequently operates at or near capacity, particularly during school drop-off and pick-up hours, when vehicle queues, limited manoeuvring space, and restricted visibility are common.

2. Impact of Nearby Primary School

The immediate vicinity includes a primary school with a pupil capacity exceeding 1,000 students. This generates exceptionally high volumes of pedestrian and vehicular activity during morning and afternoon peak periods. Large numbers of children, parents, pushchairs, and cyclists use the surrounding pavements and crossings, creating a highly sensitive highway environment.

Any further intensification of traffic would materially increase risks to child safety and exacerbate existing congestion.

3. Cumulative Impact from Recreational and Elderly Facilities

In addition to the school, the area is served by recreational facilities including tennis courts and an elderly residents' golf facility. These uses generate steady vehicle circulation and parking demand throughout the day and into the evening.

Importantly, the presence of elderly users increases the vulnerability profile of the area, as many may have reduced mobility or slower crossing speeds, requiring heightened highway safety considerations.

4. Traffic Generation from Assembly-Based Use

The proposed introduction of a community hall, temple, mosque, church, or similar assembly use would result in concentrated arrival and departure patterns, particularly during evenings, weekends, and special events.

Unlike residential development, assembly uses typically create simultaneous peak traffic movements, leading to:

Intensified congestion

Increased on-street parking stress

Obstructive and unsafe parking practices

Reduced visibility at junctions

Impeded access for emergency vehicles

This pattern of traffic generation would compound existing pressures rather than operate independently of them.

5. Highway Safety and Residential Amenity

When considered cumulatively, the existing high pedestrian activity, vulnerable users (children and elderly residents), and established congestion levels demonstrate that the site is unsuitable for further high-intensity assembly use.

The proposal would:

Materially worsen highway safety conditions

Increase risks to pedestrians

Diminish residential amenity

Undermine the safe operation of the surrounding road network